When your code is behaving in unexpected ways, you can try printing to logs or the console to diagnose the problem. Unfortunately, there are times when this sort of error tracking is not effective in finding the root cause of a problem. When you actually need to journey into your running source code, the debugger is your best companion.

The debugger can also help you if you want to learn about the Rails source code but don't know where to start. Just debug any request to your application and use this guide to learn how to move from the code you have written into the underlying Rails code.

3.1 Setup

You can use the byebug gem to set breakpoints and step through live code in Rails. To install it, just run:

```
$ gem install byebug
$ gem install byebug
```

```
class PeopleController < ApplicationController
  def new
byebug
@person = Person.new end
end
class PeopleController < ApplicationController
def new
byebug
@person = Person.new end
end
```

```
[1, 10] in /PathTo/project/app/controllers/articles_controller.rb
```